



Palate

BRAND GUIDELINES · V1

Cook first. Read later, if you feel like it.

A recipe site built the other way round: the recipe is at the top, filtered by how it actually tastes.

INSTRUCTION FIRST

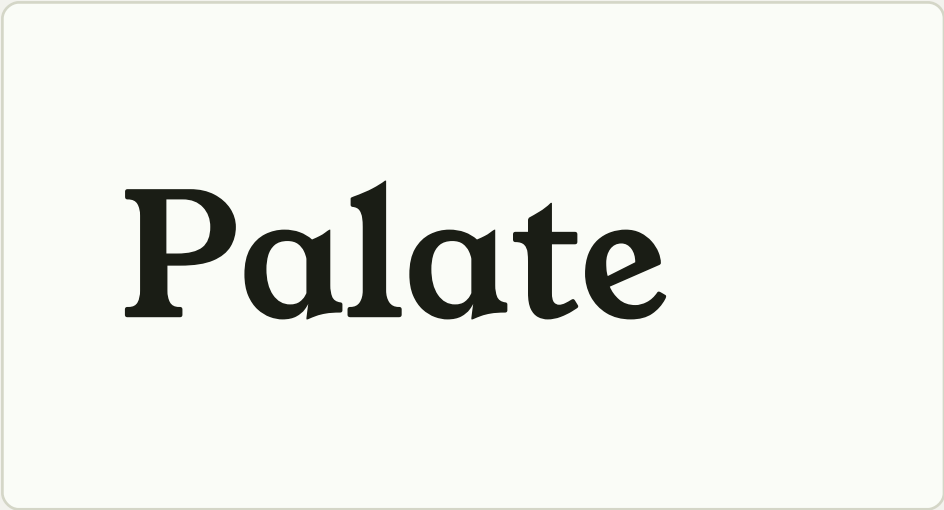
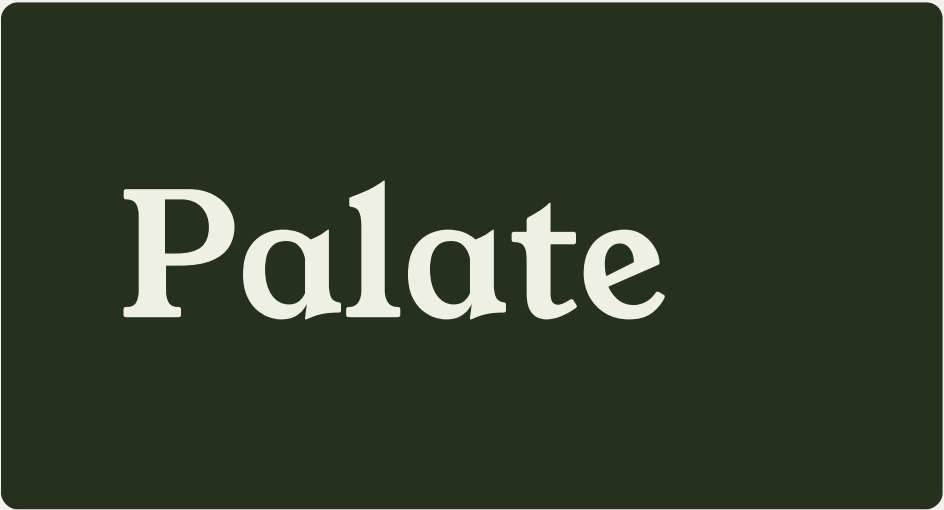
The recipe leads. Stories, notes, and essays are kept — behind a toggle, after the cooking, never in the way. The brand never buries the food.

HONEST BY DEFAULT

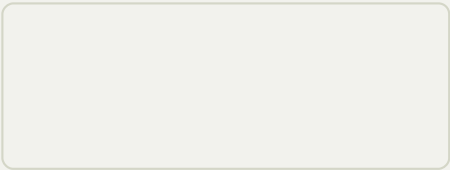
Partner cards are marked. Ratings are real votes, never seeded. Estimates say so. If the brand makes a claim, the product keeps it.

WARM RESTRAINT

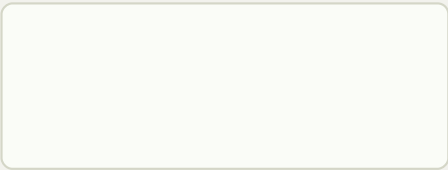
One flame accent over calm paper. Wit in small doses — "Notes, if you feel like it" — and sentence case everywhere. Never shouty, never cute twice in a row.

The word "Palate" is displayed in a black serif font on a white background. The letters are well-spaced and the font is a classic Young Serif Regular.The word "Palate" is displayed in a white serif font on a dark, solid background. The letters are well-spaced and the font is a classic Young Serif Regular.

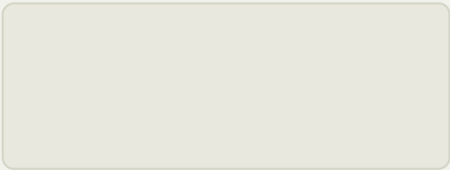
- | | |
|---------------------|--|
| FACE | Young Serif Regular, always. Never bold, never italic, never letterspaced, never outlined. |
| CASE | Sentence case — "Palate". Never all-caps, never lowercase. |
| COLOUR | Ink on paper surfaces; milk on pan surfaces. Flame is for actions and accents, not the wordmark. |
| CLEAR SPACE | Keep a margin of at least the cap height of the P on every side. |
| MINIMUM SIZE | 24 px tall on screen; 8 mm in print. Below that, use the flame rule alone. |



PAPER #F1F2EC
The room. Default background.



CARD #FBFCF7
Tickets, panels, surfaces.



WASH #E7E9DF
Bands and quiet fills.



RULE #D3D6C8
Hairlines and dotted leaders.



SLATE #5D6455
Secondary text.



INK #1A1D15
Primary text. Near-black, warm.



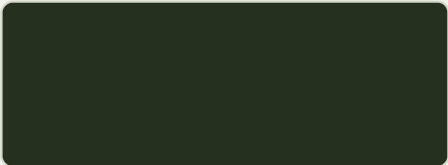
FLAME #E4572E
THE accent. Actions, highlights.



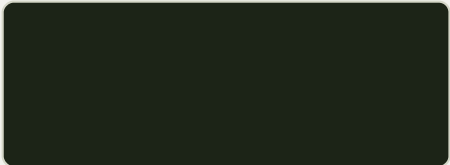
FLAME DEEP #C33F1A
Hover and pressed states.



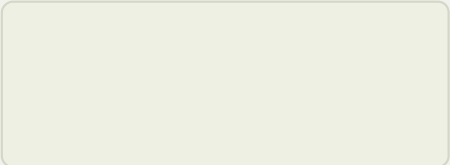
BUTTER #E9B44C
Rare warm garnish.



PAN #26301F
Dark surfaces — hero, footer.



PAN DEEP #1C2417
Deepest ground, scrims.

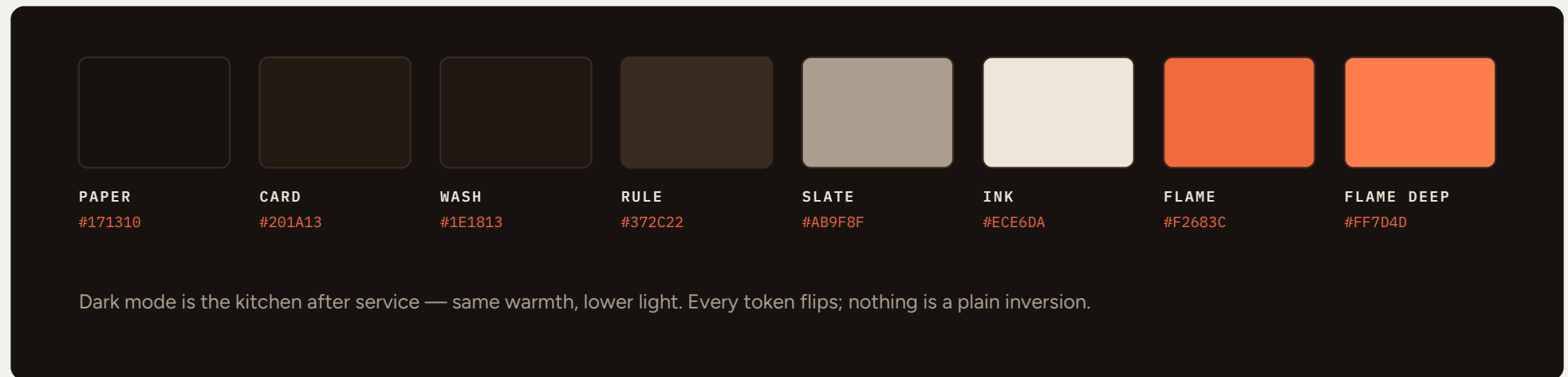


MILK #EEF0E4
Text on pan.

PROPORTION



FLAME IS SCARCE ON PURPOSE — ABOUT 5% OF ANY COMPOSITION. SCARCITY IS WHAT MAKES IT READ



THE TASTE AXES

Four axes score every recipe 0–5. Their colours also band nutrition: richness = low, sweetness = medium, heat = high.

 **HEAT**
#C2412A

 **SWEETNESS**
#B07F22

 **RICHNESS**
#5D6B38

 **EFFORT**
#46506A

Weeknight Shakshuka

YOUNG SERIF — THE HEADLINE VOICE

Display and titles only. One weight exists; that is the point. Tight leading (0.9–1.05), size does the talking.

PREP 10 MIN • SERVES 4 • £1.20 A PLATE

IBM PLEX MONO — THE TICKET PRINTER

Every label, number, and measurement. Uppercase with wide tracking (0.08–0.16em) for eyebrows; tabular figures always.

Heat the oil in a heavy pan and brown the steak all over, about 8–10 minutes.

FIGTREE — THE PLAIN SPEAKING VOICE

Method text and UI prose. Comfortable measure (~65 characters), generous line height (1.5–1.6).

SCALE (WEB)

Display clamp(2.75rem → 6rem) · H2 1.5rem · body 1–1.19rem · eyebrow 0.6875rem caps · datum 0.8125rem mono

garlic cloves 2

THE DOTTED LEADER — SIGNATURE DEVICE

Label, dots, value: the grammar of menus and kitchen tickets. The dots only appear when a value is coming.

ONE-PAN

MAKE-AHEAD

CHIPS — TAPE ON A SHELF

Square-ish corners, mono caps. Selected = inverted to ink, never tinted.

THE FLAME RULE



THE ANNOTATION DOT — ONE COLOUR, SOFT GLOW

PHOTOGRAPHY

- Full colour, always — never dimmed, tinted, or duotoned. The food is the product.
- Texture over gloss. Real shadows, real steam, torn bread, a used spoon.
- Overhead or 45°. The plate fills the frame; backgrounds stay quiet and warm.
- Step photos answer "does mine look right?" — shoot the moment of change.
- Text sits on paper or on a scrim edge — never across the middle of a dish.

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- ✗ Dim, tint, or duotone food photography — legibility comes from layout, not from muting the dish.
 - ✗ Use flame as a background colour or let it exceed ~5% of a composition.
 - ✗ Set the wordmark in anything but Young Serif Regular, or letterspace it.
 - ✗ Introduce gradients, drop shadows on type, or a fourth typeface.
 - ✗ Round corners past 8px — this is a ticket, not a bubble.
 - ✗ Use Title Case or ALL CAPS in prose. Caps live only in mono eyebrows.
 - ✗ Seed, fake, or imply ratings and reviews. The brand is the honesty.
 - ✗ Bury a recipe under a story. The toggle exists so it never has to.